

BURAK YUKSEL

Poole, Dorset, UK | Mobile: 07450 955663 | Email: [beyuksel96@gmail.com](mailto:beyuksel96@gmail.com)

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/burak-yuksel96](https://www.linkedin.com/in/burak-yuksel96) | Website: [burakyuksel.dev](http://burakyuksel.dev)

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Programme Manager with 6+ years' experience delivering complex technology initiatives within regulated financial services across Discover and Barclays. Currently leading multi-team delivery within Discover's Token Requestor Device Centric (TRDC) digital payments domain. Strong in programme execution, governance, testing readiness alignment, dependency management and data-driven performance analysis. Recognised as a structured, reliable and proactive delivery lead who operates confidently under pressure across matrix environments.

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## CORE SKILLS

**Product & Programme Delivery:** End-to-end delivery, integrated milestone planning, release roadmap, dependency & critical path management, implementation coordination

**Governance & Risk:** RAID management, ROAM practices, scope control, executive reporting, audit-aligned delivery in regulated environments

**Testing & Execution:** Test readiness alignment, environment coordination, release validation, structured defect triage, controlled implementation

**Agile & Methods:** Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, sprint planning, backlog governance, acceptance criteria definition, structured reviews

**Performance & Data Insight:** Predictability tracking, cycle time reduction, Tableau dashboards, bottleneck analysis, evidence-based decision support

**Stakeholder & Matrix Leadership:** Cross-functional alignment (engineering, product, risk/compliance), third-party coordination (Capital One Merger activity), UK-India distributed teams

**Tools & Technology:** Jira, Confluence, Miro, SharePoint, Tableau | AWS, Terraform, Jenkins, Chef, Ruby, OpenShift

**Modern Delivery:** Prompt engineering, AI-assisted documentation & workflow optimisation (Codex, GitHub Copilot), incremental "ship small" approach

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Discover Financial Services / Agile Programme Manager → Technical Programme Manager**  
**Mar 2025 – Present**

Lead delivery across 7 engineering teams (~40+ engineers) within Discover's TRDC digital payments domain.

- Own end-to-end execution of high-priority digital payment initiatives aligned to strategic objectives
- Translate business goals into structured implementation plans with integrated milestones and dependency mapping

- Coordinate engineering managers, teams, Product Owners and risk/compliance stakeholders across matrix structures
  - Partner with Technology and QA to align test readiness, environment planning and deployment sequencing
  - Maintain structured RAID governance and provide concise executive updates on risks, timelines and decisions
  - Improved multi-team delivery predictability from 65% to 85% across 7 teams by introducing structured capacity modelling, dependency governance and proactive planning
  - Reduced epic cycle time from 100+ days to ~55 days through refinement discipline and bottleneck analysis
  - Increased backlog maturity to 2+ months of delivery-ready work
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#### **Discover Financial Services / Scrum Master / Mar 2024 – Mar 2025**

- Facilitated sprint ceremonies across UK and India teams delivering digital wallet capabilities
  - Introduced structured delivery metrics and predictability reporting
  - Improved release stability through enhanced dependency visibility and risk management
  - Operated as Product Owner proxy to maintain backlog clarity and prioritisation discipline
  - Contributed to post-implementation reviews to drive continuous improvement
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#### **Barclaycard (Barclays) / DevOps Engineer → Scrum Master / Jun 2018 – Mar 2024**

Progressed from engineer into delivery leadership within a regulated banking environment.

- Led two cross-functional teams delivering secure AWS-based platforms within regulated financial systems
  - Managed end-to-end JBOSS6 → JBOSS7 migration including planning, testing coordination and controlled implementation
  - Supported organisation-wide Jira migration to improve governance transparency and reporting
  - Improved predictability to 80%+ and reduced backlog waste by 33% through structured workflow optimisation
  - Partnered with security and compliance teams to ensure regulatory and operational alignment
  - Supported migration from on-prem infrastructure to AWS cloud platforms
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#### **EDUCATION**

BSc (Hons) Software Engineering

Bournemouth University | First Class Honours | 2014 – 2018

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#### **CERTIFICATIONS**

Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I)

SAFe Practitioner (previously held)

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (in progress)